Rogue feature – Sneak Attack · SRD 5.2.1

Sneak Attack adds **extra damage** once per turn when the rogue hits with a **Finesse** or **ranged** weapon. You need **advantage**, or an **ally** within 5 ft of the target (not Incapacitated), with no **disadvantage**.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. **Finesse** or **ranged** weapon.
2. You need **Advantage**, or an **ally** within 5 ft of the target.
3. **Once per turn**, even on a Reaction.
4. Damage: **1d6** at level 1, +1d6 every 2 levels.

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 rephrases the rule: advantage suffices, and an adjacent ally can replace it as long as there's no disadvantage.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The SRD doesn't state whether the ally must be **conscious**: it only must not be Incapacitated. Fix: an unconscious ally doesn't count.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe a precise strike taking advantage of an opening.

Step 1 – Weapon:

Finesse or ranged.

Step 2 – Condition:

Advantage on the attack roll, **or** a non-Incapacitated ally within 5 ft of the target.

Step 3 – No disadvantage:

With disadvantage, no Sneak Attack (even with an ally).

Step 4 – Hit:

If the attack hits, add the Sneak Attack dice.

Step 5 – Limit:

Once per turn (so also on a Reaction, once per turn).

Example: Lyra (level 3) hits an ogre with a rapier, an ally within 5 ft: +2d6 damage. Later, on a Reaction, she hits another enemy: she can add 2d6 again.

⚠ Common questions:

Once per what?

Per turn, not per round.

And on a Reaction?

Yes, it's another turn.

Must the ally be conscious?

It must not be Incapacitated.

Ally's maximum distance?

5 ft from the target.

Disadvantage?

It cancels Sneak Attack.

Two-handed weapon?

Only if it has Finesse or range.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Ally at range

Does an ally 10 ft away count?
Option: no, exactly 5 ft.

Invisible ally

Does it count? **Option**: yes if conscious.

Spells

Does an attack spell trigger it?
Option: no, weapons only.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Advantage

Advantage without an adjacent ally suffices.

Disadvantage

Even with an ally, disadvantage prevents it.

Once per turn

Including on another creature's turn.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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